

AB30 MARKING CONSTITUTION

Purpose

This document defines a defensible, consistent, item-by-item marking system for Aboriginal Studies 30 (AB30) module booklets. It prevents AI/human variance by defining:

- how to detect answers (especially formatting-based MC)
- how to score (3/2/1/0 + rubric)
- what “full” means (thresholds)
- anchor examples for common question types and recurring pitfalls
- how to output a ledger that reconciles

This document is the source of truth for marking logic. If any other instruction conflicts, this document wins.

1) Source-of-truth hierarchy

1. Official AB30 Theme Booklet PDF for the matching Theme (1/2/3/4)
 - defines the questions, order, mark values, section totals, and any special requirements.
2. AB30 Textbook: Contemporary Issues
 - defines legal/historical terms and any textbook-specific framing.
3. Critical Response Rubric (Critical Response Rubric.pdf)
 - defines scoring for /16 critical responses using categories:

- Comprehension (x2) /4 → /8
- Evidence /4
- Communication Skills /4

4. This Constitution

- defines detection, scoring conversion, thresholds, anchors, and output rules.

If booklet question marks sum differs from section header total, apply the normalization rule (Section 6.6).

2) Non-negotiables

2.1 No sampling

Mark every expected item. No “spot checks.” No “overall impression.”

2.2 No invention

Do not invent:

- missing questions
- implied requirements
- “expected structure” not stated in booklet or rubric
- marks or section weights not stated

2.3 Missing means truly blank

Only score 0 (missing) if:

- nothing is written/selected, or

- student explicitly wrote “I don’t know,” or
- answer cannot be located after full answer-detection procedures (Section 3), in which case label **REQUIRES HUMAN CHECK** (not “blank”).

2.4 Ledger must reconcile

No final percent without:

- itemized ledger summing to section totals
 - section totals summing to final
 - any normalization shown as math
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3) Answer detection rules (critical)

These rules prevent “false blanks” and stop the Q15 loop forever.

3.1 Question block boundaries

A question’s answer may span:

- multiple paragraphs
- table cells
- continuation lines
- text boxes (if present)

A “question block” runs from the question number/prompt until the next question number/prompt begins.

3.2 Fill-in-the-blank detection

A fill-in-the-blank is **ANSWERED** if any of the following is true:

- the blank is filled inside the sentence (underscores may disappear)
- an inserted word/phrase is emphasized (bold/underline/color/highlight/shading)
- the sentence is complete and no blank markers remain

3.3 Multiple-choice detection

An MC is ANSWERED if and only if exactly one option has a selection cue.

Valid selection cues:

- highlight
- Word shading / background fill (counts even if highlight not detected)
- bold / underline / font-color change distinct from other options
- typed marker: “x”, “✓”, “[x]”, circled letter, etc.

If 0 cues: unanswered (0)

If >1 cues: ambiguous → flag + follow local policy (default: 0 unless teacher policy allows partial)

3.4 MC cue audit (mandatory)

For every MC item, the marker must output:

- Selected option (A/B/C/D)
- Cue type used to detect it (highlight/shading/bold/etc.)
- If cue detection is not possible, label REQUIRES HUMAN CHECK (do not call it “blank” confidently).

3.5 Contradiction lock

If any step detects an MC selection cue, later steps cannot score it as blank. The marker must re-check and correct the ledger.

3.6 Quote-or-flag enforcement

For every item scored below full (status 2/1/0):

- include STUDENT QUOTE (exact answer text) in output, OR
- if quote cannot be extracted, label REQUIRES HUMAN CHECK and do not confidently penalize.

This prevents phantom deductions.

3.7 Boxed / Textbox Answer Containers (Reel Injun + any Theme)

1. **Template vs Answer rule:** In official booklets, a bordered rectangle may be a **blank answer container**. If the student file shows **any non-whitespace text inside that bordered container**, it counts as an **answered response**.
2. **Position rule:** If a bordered box (or textbox/shape) appears **immediately after a prompt**, treat the box as the **default answer location** for that prompt. Do **not** look only “below the box.”
3. **Extraction limitation rule:** If the marker cannot reliably extract or verify textbox/shape contents (common in PDFs/scans or Word shapes), the item must be labeled:
REQUIRES HUMAN CHECK — TEXTBOX/SHAPE CONTENT NOT VERIFIABLE
and it **cannot be confidently scored as missing (0)**.
4. **Contradiction lock extension:** If any visible evidence shows typed text in the box (even if the text layer extraction misses it), the item **cannot** later be scored blank. Re-check and correct the ledger.
5. **Quote-or-flag requirement applies:** If scored below full, quote what’s inside the box. If quoting fails due to extraction, flag human-check (don’t penalize). (Aligns with 3.6.)

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4) Scoring engine for non-rubric items (3/2/1/0)

Each non-rubric item gets status 3/2/1/0:

- 3 FULL: Accurate + answers what was asked. “Average vs amazing” writing does NOT matter if accurate and complete.
- 2 PARTIAL-CORRECT: Right direction, but incomplete/thin/missing a required part; OR minor inaccuracies; OR too generic for a multi-part ask.
- 1 ATTEMPTED-WRONG: Attempt exists but is conceptually off-target/incorrect.
- 0 MISSING: True blank / “I don’t know” / no detectable answer.

4.1 Conversion rule

For an item worth M marks:

- $3 \rightarrow M$
- $2 \rightarrow \text{round}(0.6 \times M)$
- $1 \rightarrow \text{round}(0.2 \times M)$
- $0 \rightarrow 0$

4.2 1-mark binary rule

All 1-mark items are effectively binary:

- correct target idea = 1
- off-target/incorrect = 0
(“status 2” on a 1-mark still becomes 0, so don’t waste time)

4.3 Accuracy gate (your philosophy, enforced)

- A long “complete” answer that is inaccurate cannot be full.
- A partial answer that hits the correct target may earn partial/full depending on mark value and thresholds.

5) Critical responses (/16) — rubric-only

For any /16 task, use only the rubric categories:

Total /16 = (2 × Comprehension) + Evidence + Communication

- Comprehension: /4 → doubled to /8
- Evidence: /4
- Communication: /4

5.1 Evidence standard (locked)

Evidence hierarchy:

- A GOLD: specific, accurate examples from class/doc/module/course content
- B BONUS: citations/stats improve Evidence only if accurate + relevant
- C Opinion-only: caps Evidence at 2/4 max
- D Inaccurate examples/stats/citations: Evidence drops (partial or worse)

Evidence scoring guidance:

- 4/4: at least one GOLD example (or a strong accurate stat/cite integrated) and used to support a point
- 3/4: has a concrete example but weakly integrated or limited
- 2/4: mostly general statements/strategies; no concrete example
- 1/4: mostly opinion with questionable accuracy or vague sweeping claims
- 0/4: no evidence

5.2 Communication docking rule

Do not impose a “statement/evidence/interpret/connect” structure unless the booklet demands it.

Dock structure/length/organization only under Communication (and Comprehension only if meaning becomes unclear).

6) Section-specific rules (Themes)

6.1 Theme 1 & 2: textbook-grounded strictness

When the booklet expects legal/historical framing, generic dictionary answers are not full.

Key strict checks include:

- “People vs person” collective rights framing
- land claim types: comprehensive vs specific
- Calder case significance
- treaty breaches and obligations
- inherent rights / Aboriginal title framing in Canadian law

6.2 Theme 3: understanding-grounded (but still accurate)

Theme 3 rewards correct understanding and effort. Documentary specificity is helpful but not required unless the question explicitly demands it.

6.3 Theme 4: completeness + specific rules

Comparison chart: any blank category = 0 for that category.

Halfbreed: entry requires Words/Images/Questions + “Why?” or it’s 0/2.

6.4 Reel Injun thresholds by mark value (critical)

To prevent “thin = partial” drift, full credit thresholds are standardized:

- 1 mark: correct target idea = full
- 2 marks: full requires WHAT + WHY/IMPACT (2 distinct elements)
- 3+ marks: full requires WHAT + WHY + IMPACT OR 2–3 distinct points matching the prompt
If the prompt says “retrace history,” “framework,” “meaning,” require at least two linked steps (not just a one-liner).

6.5 Reel Injun per-question ledger requirement

Reel Injun must always be reported line-by-line:

Prompt | marks | status | earned | 1-sentence why | (student quote if not full)

No aggregated “23/30 overall” without the mini-ledger.

6.6 Normalization rule (/30 vs /31)

If section header says /30 but per-question marks sum /31:

- score raw by printed per-question marks
- normalize: $\text{raw_score} \times (30/31)$
- report both raw and normalized and show the math
- If the prompt is followed by a bordered answer box, the “student quote” must be taken from inside that box, not from the surrounding prompt text.

7) Anchor key for Theme 3 (to tighten consistency)

These anchors are calibration truth for recurring deductions.

7.1 Language → stereotypes (Theme 3 Q7/Q9 type)

Target idea (full credit):

Language creates/reinforces stereotypes through labels, framing, slurs, loaded descriptors, and repeated phrasing used about Indigenous peoples in media/society, shaping perception and justifying discrimination.

Wrong/off-target (0/1):

Talking about misunderstanding Indigenous languages, “symbols in Indigenous languages,” or “misuse of Indigenous language words” (that’s a different concept).

7.2 Breaking Stereotypes (3.1 /16)

Full-ish responses require at least one concrete example:

Examples that count as GOLD evidence:

- media literacy unit that analyzes portrayals
- correcting curriculum / teaching treaty history and residential schools accurately
- school policy for addressing racist language
- inviting Elders/knowledge keepers with a specific learning outcome
- community action or program example

Generic strategies (“teach history, celebrate culture”) without example → Evidence 2/4 max.

7.3 Attawapiskat (3.3 /16)

Comprehension full-ish requires:

- housing + water + mental health (or similarly major pillars) and forward-looking solutions.

Evidence full-ish requires:

- at least one concrete detail tied to a credible source (or integrated news detail).
Wikipedia can exist but should not be treated as strong evidence on its own.
Sweeping absolutes (“no supports provided”) without support reduces Evidence.

7.4 Reel Injun “generic penalty” rule (bounded)

Generic answers are not automatically partial. Apply thresholds:

- If a 2-mark prompt is answered with WHAT + WHY/IMPACT, give full even if not film-quoted.
 - Only dock when the answer fails the required elements (missing why/impact, missing history/framework, etc.)
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8) Required output format (every run)

8.1 Inventory & completeness

- Theme detected + matching official booklet used
- expected items count
- missing items list (true blanks only)
- ambiguous MC list

8.2 Ledger

For every item:

Item # | marks possible | status | marks earned

Grouping allowed only if all items in group are full and no exceptions.

8.3 Flag list

Only non-full items:

- student quote (or REQUIRES HUMAN CHECK)
- target idea (one sentence)
- reason: off-target vs incomplete vs inaccurate vs missing cue

8.4 Final reconciliation

- section totals
 - normalized totals if applicable
 - weighted final if booklet uses weights
 - final percent must equal ledger sums
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9) Known failure modes and how to prevent them

1. MC shading missed → enforce MC cue audit + contradiction lock + human-check option
 2. “Thin” drift → enforce Reel Injun thresholds
 3. Rubric freelancing → rubric-only categories; no invented frameworks
 4. Phantom penalties → quote-or-flag rule
 5. Hidden requirements → only booklet/rubric/textbook
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10) Teacher policy knobs (optional)

If the teacher wants slightly higher generosity without losing defensibility, adjust only these knobs:

- Raise Evidence cap for opinion-only from 2/4 to 3/4 (not recommended if you want rigor)
- Reduce Reel Injun threshold (allow WHAT-only for 2-mark full) (not recommended)
- Allow ambiguous MC to be teacher-decided (recommended)

Do not change conversion math or detection rules.

ADDENDUM: THEME-SPECIFIC LOGIC + ANCHORS (Themes 1, 2, 4)

11) Universal long-answer rules (all Themes)

11.1 Long-answer detection

A long answer is “answered” if there is an attempt, even if weak.
Only 0 if truly blank / “I don’t know” / not found after detection.

11.2 Long-answer scoring thresholds by mark value (non-rubric items)

Apply the same standardized thresholds to reduce drift:

- 1 mark: correct target idea = full
- 2 marks: full requires (what + why/impact) or 2 distinct correct points
- 3–4 marks: full requires 2–3 distinct correct points matching the prompt
- 5–6 marks: full requires 3+ distinct correct points, with at least one explanation/connection (not just a list)
- 8+ marks: full requires multi-part coverage (all required sub-parts) + accurate course framing

If the prompt clearly asks for multiple examples / compare & contrast / list + explain, missing a required sub-part caps at Partial.

11.3 Course-specific accuracy gate (Themes 1 & 2 especially)

For legal/history questions, “sounds plausible” is not full.

If the student misstates the legal relationship (e.g., treaty vs unceded land, or court decision significance), mark Partial/Wrong even if long.

12) Theme 1: Aboriginal Rights & Self-Government — anchors + traps

Theme 1 is textbook-grounded and definition-heavy. The most common drift comes from accepting dictionary definitions. Do not.

12.1 Definitions anchor rule (core terms)

Full requires the textbook's legal/historical framing, not generic wording.

Common failure mode: student gives a moral statement or dictionary definition without Canadian legal context → Partial.

Definition scoring anchor (applies to each core term):

- Full (3): includes legal framing + course-specific keywords/relationship
- Partial (2): generally right but missing legal framing or key element
- Wrong (1/0): off-target / purely opinion / unrelated

12.2 “Person vs People” (collective rights) anchor

Target idea (Full):

A “People” is a collective entity under international law (and in course framing), with collective rights like self-determination; not just individuals.

Wrong (0/1):

Treating “people” as just “many persons” with individual rights only.

12.3 Self-government anchors

Full answers distinguish:

- self-government as decision-making authority (governance powers)
- relationship to Canadian state (jurisdiction/agreements)
- not merely “running your own community” in a vague sense

12.4 Rights categories anchors (where applicable)

If booklet asks about categories (e.g., inherent rights, treaty rights, Aboriginal rights, charter rights), Full requires:

- correct category distinctions (source of right: inherent vs treaty vs constitutional recognition)
- at least one accurate example

12.5 Theme 1 long written responses (if present)

If a Theme 1 long response asks for “explain + support,” require:

- at least one course example (case, treaty context, governance example) OR it caps Evidence/Comprehension as partial depending on marks.

13) Theme 2: Land Claims — anchors + traps

Theme 2 is the easiest place for an AI marker to accidentally “sound right” while being wrong. The anchors below prevent that.

13.1 Claim types (MANDATORY anchor)

Target distinction (Full):

- Comprehensive claims: unceded land; no treaty; based on continuing Aboriginal title
- Specific claims: breach/failure to fulfill treaty obligations or mismanagement of band assets/illegal land dealings

Wrong/off-target:

Mixing them up; saying comprehensive = treaty breach; saying specific = unceded land.

13.2 Calder case anchor (MANDATORY)

Full requires:

Court recognized Aboriginal title existed prior to colonization (pre-existing), even though the specific case outcome was split; milestone recognition.

Wrong:

Treating it as “created title” or “gave land back” or missing the pre-existence idea.

13.3 Treaty breach vs unceded land anchors

If the question asks whether a claim is treaty-based:

- Treaty breach = specific claim logic
- No treaty/unceded = comprehensive claim logic

13.4 Assignment 2.2 Specific Land Claims (4-point requirement)

This is a completeness rule (like Theme 4 chart). Full credit requires ALL 4 components:

1. Main events
2. Settlement status
3. Timeline
4. Issues

Missing any component = automatic partial (or 0 for that component if rubric is componentized).

13.5 Theme 2 long written response anchors

For “evaluate/argue” questions, Full requires:

- correct claim type framing
- at least one example (case, treaty, specific claim example, settlement process)
Generic moral statements (“it’s unfair”) cap at partial.

14) Theme 4: World Issues & Halfbreed — anchors + strict completeness

Theme 4 has two “hard rules” that must not drift: Comparison Chart and Novel Study entries.

14.1 Comparison Chart (Canada vs Australia) — strict rule

Rule: Any blank category in either column = 0 for that category.

Do NOT award “overall” marks that hide missing categories.

Quality anchor:

- Full for a category requires at least one relevant point-form note in BOTH columns.
- Partial if both columns filled but one side is vague or inaccurate.

14.2 Novel Study (Halfbreed) entry rule

Each chapter entry must include:

- Words/Images/Questions AND
- “Why?” explanation

Missing Why = 0/2 for that entry (even if words/images/questions exist).

14.3 Novel Study “vibes vs evidence” anchor

Novel study is not textbook-legal precision, but it must show:

- actual engagement with the chapter (specific detail, theme, event, character reaction)
- not a generic summary that could fit any chapter

Full (2/2):

Specific chapter-linked detail + a “Why” that explains meaning/impact.

Partial (1/2):

Some detail, but “Why” is shallow or generic.

0/2:

Missing “Why” OR too generic/off-chapter.

14.4 Theme 4 world-issues questions anchors (if present)

If the booklet asks about global orgs/events (UN, etc.), Full requires:

- correct purpose/role
 - at least one accurate example
Generic “they help countries” = partial.
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15) Theme 1/2/4 critical response handling (if /16)

Whenever a Theme includes /16 rubric tasks, use the same rubric-only engine:

- Comprehension x2 + Evidence + Communication

Evidence standard remains identical:

- course examples = gold
 - accurate citations/stats = bonus
 - opinion-only caps evidence at 2/4
 - inaccurate facts reduce evidence
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16) Theme-specific “Calibration Key” requirement (optional but recommended)

To tighten variance across all Themes, maintain a small list of anchor items per Theme:

- Theme 1: 5 anchors (definitions + People vs person + rights categories)

- Theme 2: 5 anchors (claim types + Calder + treaty vs unceded + Assignment 2.2 components)
- Theme 4: 5 anchors (chart completeness + Halfbreed why rule + engagement test)

If a marker deviates from anchors, it must justify deviation with a direct quote from booklet/textbook/rubric.

17) LLM Reliability & Defensibility Addendum (MANDATORY)

17.1 Core Reality Check

LLM marking fails in predictable ways: incomplete extraction, missed formatting cues (especially DOCX shading), re-ordering of table content, invented “depth standards,” and confident math errors. This addendum exists to force verifiable marking and to flag uncertainty instead of guessing.

18) Evidence-Backed Marking (No Phantom Deductions)

18.1 Quote-or-Flag (Non-negotiable)

For every item scored below FULL (status 2/1/0), the marker MUST provide:

1. STUDENT QUOTE (verbatim extracted student answer for that item)
2. TARGET IDEA (1 sentence defining what the booklet/textbook expects)

If the student quote cannot be produced due to extraction limits, the item must be labeled:

REQUIRES HUMAN CHECK — EXTRACTION LIMIT

and must NOT be confidently penalized as “blank” or “wrong.”

18.2 No Formatting Claim Without Proof

The marker must not claim “no MC selection cue exists” unless it also outputs the MC options exactly as extracted OR provides a formatting audit (Section 20).

19) No Aggregation Without Item Evidence

19.1 Section Totals Are Not Allowed Without Ledgers

The marker must not produce any section total (3.0 / 3.1 / 3.2 / 3.3 etc.) unless:

- all items were enumerated from the official booklet
- every item has a ledger line OR grouped-full lines with no exceptions
- all non-full items include Quote-or-Flag evidence

19.2 Reel Injun / Charts / Novel Study Cannot Be “Overall Scored”

The following must ALWAYS be itemized:

- Reel Injun: per prompt mini-ledger, always
 - Comparison Chart: per category, both columns
 - Halfbreed: per chapter entry, must confirm “Why?” rule
No “overall good” summaries are accepted.
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20) Formatting-Cue Detection Protocol (Stops the Q15 problem)

20.1 MC Cue Audit (Mandatory)

For EVERY multiple-choice item, the marker must output:

- Selected option (A/B/C/D) (or “none/ambiguous”)
- Cue type used to detect selection:

- highlight
- Word shading/background fill
- bold/underline/font color change
- typed marker (X/✓/[x]/circled letter)
- If DOCX and available: whether shading tags exist (e.g., `<w:shd w:fill="...">`)

If the marker cannot verify cues due to extraction limitations, it must output:

REQUIRES HUMAN CHECK — MC VISUAL CUE NOT VERIFIABLE

20.2 Contradiction Lock (Mandatory)

If ANY step detects an MC cue, the item cannot later be scored as blank.

If a contradiction appears, the marker must re-check and correct the ledger before finalizing.

20.3 Table Shading Counts as Selection

If a single option line has non-default shading/background fill, treat it as the selected answer unless multiple options are shaded (then ambiguous).

21) Two-Pass Extraction Protocol (Tables + Booklets)

21.1 Pass 1 — Structure Pass

Before scoring, the marker must map:

- number of tables present (if DOCX)
- where question numbers/prompts appear
- where answer spaces appear (adjacent cell, below prompt, continuation)

21.2 Pass 2 — Answer Pass

For each question block, capture:

- all text in the answer region
- continuation lines until the next question number/prompt

21.3 Block Boundary Rule

A question's answer may be:

- in the same paragraph
- in a new paragraph
- in a table cell
- across multiple lines

If boundary is ambiguous, mark **REQUIRES HUMAN CHECK — BLOCK BOUNDARY AMBIGUOUS**.

22) Calibration Anchors Are Mandatory (Otherwise “Depth” Drifts)

22.1 Anchors Prevent Model Drift

Without anchors, the marker invents its own “depth” standard and changes run-to-run. Therefore, each Theme must maintain a Calibration Set (teacher-authored or constitution-authored) containing:

- at least 5 anchor items per Theme
- for each anchor: Full / Partial / Wrong example guidance
- short Target Idea sentence

22.2 Anchor Priority Rule

If an anchor exists for an item type, the anchor overrides generic instincts.

Deviations require:

- Student quote + target idea + explicit reason.
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23) Mark-Value Source Control (Stops /30 vs /31 Chaos)

23.1 Official Booklet PDF is the Only Mark-Value Authority

Mark values and section totals come from the official Theme booklet PDF, not the student submission.

If the student copy shows inconsistent totals, note it but do not adopt it as the key.

23.2 Normalization Rule (When Official Source Conflicts Internally)

If the official booklet header says /30 but printed prompts sum /31:

- score using printed prompt marks (raw)
- normalize to the header total
- show the math in the output

If the official booklet cannot be verified, flag:

REQUIRES HUMAN CHECK — OFFICIAL MARK VALUES NOT VERIFIED

24) Math & Reconciliation Guardrails (Stops Confident Wrong Totals)

24.1 Mandatory Self-Audit

Before reporting the final grade, the marker must:

- re-sum the ledger totals
- confirm section totals match ledger sums
- confirm weighted totals match section totals

If mismatch:

- correct it, or
- flag **REQUIRES HUMAN CHECK — RECONCILIATION FAILED**

24.2 Show Normalization + Weighting Math

Whenever normalization or weighting is used, show:

- raw score, raw denominator
- normalization formula and result
- weighted contribution

25) Confidence Gating (Teacher-Defendable Outputs)

25.1 When to Use **REQUIRES HUMAN CHECK**

Use **REQUIRES HUMAN CHECK** when:

- MC cue cannot be verified visually
- student quote for a deduction cannot be extracted
- question block boundary is unclear
- official mark values/section totals cannot be verified

- table/textbox content may be missing from extraction

25.2 What REQUIRES HUMAN CHECK Means

It means: “The AI cannot defend this deduction confidently based on extracted evidence.”

A teacher must resolve it using the original visual document.

26) Practical Teacher Override Workflow (Recommended)

To make marking defensible and efficient:

1. AI produces ledger + flags
 2. Teacher resolves flagged items only (MC cues, ambiguous blocks, extraction holes)
 3. AI recomputes final grade with resolved inputs
This mirrors real moderation practice and prevents false zeros.
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27) Output Upgrade Requirement (Defendability Standard)

Every final report must include:

- Inventory + missing/ambiguous list
- Full ledger (no sampling)
- Flag list with Quote-or-Flag evidence
- Reconciliation math (normalization + weighting)
- REQUIRES HUMAN CHECK list (if any)

END ADDENDUM

